

Kiwi Coffee Is Not Rocket Science... Right?

Task: Fill in the blanks with the English idioms we learned last week. The simple meanings in brackets may help you choose the correct idiom.

Daniel and Mei were sitting in a café in Auckland CBD after class.

"I still can't _____ (understand something difficult) Kiwi coffee orders," Daniel sighed. "Flat white, long black, trim milk... _____ (not complicated), but somehow I panic every time."

Mei laughed. "At least you ordered successfully today. Last week you asked for a 'fat black' instead of a flat white."

Daniel covered his face. "Please _____ (don't be too critical). English is hard before caffeine."

Just then, the waiter walked toward them with two coffees.

"_____ (the person we were talking about appears)," Mei whispered. "Here comes the guy who corrected your pronunciation last time."

After the waiter left, Daniel leaned forward. "_____ (tell briefly), I think he remembers me."

"_____ (I totally agree)," Mei replied.

Daniel took a sip of coffee and looked worried. "I may have another problem," he said. "I told my landlord I could fix the leaking sink myself."

Mei almost laughed too loudly. "Daniel! Why would you do that?"

"I wanted to sound useful!"

"And now?"

"Well... after three YouTube videos, the kitchen actually looks worse."

Mei shook her head. "Maybe you should _____ (start over) and call a plumber."

Daniel sighed dramatically. "I think so too."

A moment later, Daniel checked his phone and suddenly smiled. "Good news! I passed my driving test!"

"No way!"

"Yes! After three fails!"

Mei lifted her coffee cup. "_____ (better to succeed late than never succeed)."

Daniel laughed. "Honestly, after all those mistakes, I was ready to _____ (do something difficult because it is necessary) and become a bus passenger forever."

Mei checked the time. "Wow, _____ (time passes quickly when enjoying yourself). I need to go."

Daniel stood up. "Alright, let's _____ (stop working / finish for today) before I create another problem in New Zealand."

Hang in there! Don't throw your dictionaries away yet - more idioms are on the way

A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush ---What you have is worth more than what you might have later

A penny for your thoughts ---Tell me what you're thinking

A penny saved is a penny earned ---Money you save today you can spend later

A perfect storm ---the worst possible situation

A picture is worth 1000 words ---Better to show than tell

Actions speak louder than words ---Believe what people do and not what they say

Add insult to injury ---To make a bad situation worse

Barking up the wrong tree ---To be mistaken, to be looking for solutions in the wrong place

Birds of a feather flock together ---People who are alike are often friends (usually used negatively)

Bite off more than you can chew ---Take on a project that you cannot finish

Break the ice ---Make people feel more comfortable

By the skin of your teeth ---Just barely

Comparing apples to oranges ---Comparing two things that cannot be compared